



Football



Cristiano Ronaldo and Lionel Messi are two of the most widely-known footballers in the world.

"**Football**" is a word which could mean one of several sports. The best-known type of football is association football. This is called "soccer" in the United States, Canada and Australia to avoid confusion with other types of football that are commonly played there.

The name "football" comes from the two words "foot" and "ball". It is named "football", because the players of the game walk and often run (on their feet) while playing, as opposed to (for example) polo where the players ride horses. Football is played using a ball, also called a football, that is usually shaped like a sphere or an ellipsoid. The ball is often kicked with the foot, but depending on the game, it

can also be hit using other parts of the body (in association football) and handling the ball is a part of some other sports known as football. Players can use any part of their body except their arms and hands. Goal keepers can use every part of their body to keep the ball out of the goal.

Some elements of football have been seen in many countries, dating back to the second and third century AD in China.^[1] The modern games of rugby union, rugby league and association football comes from 19th-century England.^[2] Kicking a ball, in Europe, was described in Britannia (now western Scottish lowlands), in Germania (now Deutschland) and Gallia (now France and northern-central Italy).^[3] An evolution goes back to the Middle Ages in Paris.^[4] Association football (founded in Richmond, London at the end of 1800) spread to many other parts of Europe, and was brought to the rest of the world with colonization. Today, it is the most popular sport in the world and many people watch it on television, especially the FIFA World Cup that happens every four years.

Every year there is a Football Club Competition called as Champions League. All the qualified big teams take part. At the end, we have one winner who takes the prestigious UEFA trophy. All big players play for their own teams. Some big players who take part every year are Mbappe, Ronaldo, Messi, Pablo, Neymar and many more.

Part of a series of articles on

Sports



Summer Sports

Track and field athletics

Football (soccer)

Basketball

Bowls

Rugby

Gymnastics

Baseball

American football

Cycling·Auto racing

Cricket·Golf

Field hockey·Handball

Archery·Shooting

Fencing·Weightlifting

Pentathlon·Triathlon

Horseback riding

Water sports

Swimming·Diving

Water polo·Sailing

Canoeing·Rowing

Martial arts

Boxing·Wrestling

Karate·Taekwondo

Net sports

Tennis·Volleyball

Table tennis·Badminton

Winter sports

Types of football



A game of American (gridiron) football.  Canadian football is very similar.

- Association football (soccer)
- Rugby
- Rugby league football
- Rugby union football
- Gridiron football
- American football
- College football
- Touch rugby - Called "touch football" in Australia.
- Canadian football
- Gaelic football

- Futsal
- Australian Rules Football

References

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3. Tacitus, Annales
4. Eisenberg, Christiane and Pierre Lanfranchi, eds. 2006: Football History: international perspectives. Special Issue, *Historical Social Research* 31

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